Oneir Raza

oneirraza@gmail.com | LinkedIn

Global partnerships and strategy professional with a Cambridge MPhil and 4+ years of experience navigating the intersection of educational technology, public policy, and international development. Proven track record of managing high-stakes institutional relationships with federal ministries, academic entities, and global organizations including the World Bank and the Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation. Expert at market landscape mapping, translating complex tech/data capabilities into strategic opportunities, and serving as a cross-functional liaison between technical teams and external stakeholders. Deeply knowledgeable in global EdTech ecosystems and emerging AI applications in education.

EDUCATION

University of Cambridge — **Cambridge, United Kingdom**

MPhil in Education, Globalisation and International Development — *Oct 2023 – July 2024*

- Awarded merit-based fully funded Chevening Scholarship.
- Publication: "Exploring the gender differences in the use of EdTech amongst students in developing economies."

National Defence University — **Islamabad, Pakistan**

Bachelor's in International Relations — *Sept 2016 – Aug 2020*

- Awarded Merit Award and a Chancellor's Gold Medal for achieving the highest GPA in the graduating class.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Centre for Economic Research and Policy (CERP) — **Lahore, Pakistan**

Project Manager — *October 2024- Present*

- Lead the strategic design, scoping, and implementation of monitoring and evaluation (M&E) systems for a large-scale public school EdTech intervention across 341 schools, aligning frameworks with international donor requirements.
- Map the regional education technology landscape to identify emerging software capabilities, evaluate AI readiness, and flag operational gaps where external tech implementations could add direct value.
- Act as the primary cross-organizational connector between field research operations, data engineering teams, and product content developers to ensure all partner engagements reflect institutional priorities.
- Manage and clean multi-source quantitative (Stata, SQL, Excel) and qualitative (NVivo) datasets for 10,000+ participants, using tracking systems to maintain data integrity and visibility across teams.
- Translate dense technical data into short, high-level insight summaries, policy briefs, and visual dashboards to inform strategic decision-making and project pilots for government partners.
- Engage senior government counterparts, university research organizations, and community stakeholders to strengthen international education policy implementation and optimize digital service delivery.
- Facilitate regular team stand-ups to operationalize project tracking, define milestones, manage cross-team dependencies, and proactively address bottlenecks to ensure on-time delivery.

Tabadlab — **Islamabad, Pakistan**

Associate (Policy and Communications) — *Jan 2023 – August 2023*

- Managed and nurtured high-level collaborative relationships with federal ministries, private sector actors, and international donors (World Bank, BMGF), increasing stakeholder engagement by 40%.
- Spearheaded a comprehensive policy dialogue roadmap involving 20+ institutional stakeholders, resulting in 10 actionable education sector reform recommendations for senior government partners.
- Formed and operationalized a continuous knowledge-sharing Community of Practice, leading the end-to-end strategic planning, budgeting, and execution of over 15 high-impact policy roundtables.
- Led the research and writing of a policy brief titled *"Islahati Jaiza: Punjab Education Sector Reforms"* published on Tabadlab's website.
- Designed and executed targeted digital advocacy campaigns, leveraging advanced analytics and communication strategies to increase organization reach and public sector voice by 80% within six months.

Remoto — **Madrid, Spain**

Communications and Partnerships Lead — *July 2022 – December 2022*

- Identify and prospect 50+ strategic innovation and research partnerships across Europe, the UK, and the US, initiating early conversations and managing the pipeline progression from initial exploration to defined alignment.
- Strengthen internal processes for tracking active collaborations and sharing market analysis across remote, cross-functional teams to ensure clear alignment on strategic priorities.

Teach for Pakistan — **Islamabad, Pakistan**

Teaching and Leadership Fellow — *Sept 2020 – June 2022*

- Performed as a member of an internationally recognised fellowship (acceptance rate 3%) for college graduates.
- Partnered directly with government collaborating with school principals, teachers, and parents to implement targeted learning strategies, increasing average formative student math and English assessment scores from 40% to 75%.
- Planned and implemented a community project which resulted in transformational impact on 1200+ school children.
- Liaised with 20+ key stakeholders and led a community partnership project aimed at building a library in the community.
- Acted as an end-to-end program builder to launch a community literacy project impacting 1,200+ vulnerable children; drafted project proposals, built resource models, and raised 600,000 PKR through targeted networking.
- Developed and allocated project resources, prepared and managed budgets, monitored progress, and conducted comprehensive evaluations at baseline, midline, and end-line stages, ensuring successful project delivery.

SKILLS

Partnership & Pipeline Management: Relationship Management, Stakeholder Coordination, Pipeline Development, CRM Management

AI & Tech Literacy: EdTech Readiness Assessment, Digital Transformation Frameworks, Advanced Prompting Optimization (ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude)

Languages: English, Urdu, Hindi, Italian, Arabic